ABVORN

ABVORN · ROBOT VACUUMS

2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

Independent research and reviews · https://abvorn.com

We earn a commission if you buy through our links, at no extra cost to you. Our opinions are our own.

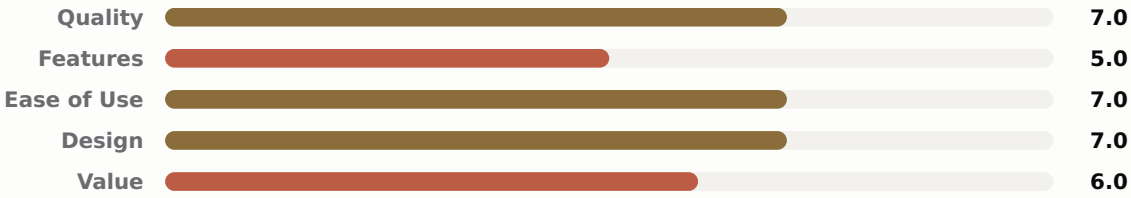
Looking for a robot vacuum that truly keeps up with 2026’s smart-home demands? The **iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock** delivers hands-free emptying and strong mopping, while the **Shark AI Ultra** offers laser-precise navigation at a lower price. Choose based on floor type, pet hair, and budget.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

The 2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Landscape

In 2026, most households expect a robot vacuum to do more than just suck up dust. AI-driven navigation that avoids cords and pet toys, simultaneous vacuum-and-mop cycles, and self-empty docks that keep the bin clean for weeks have moved from luxury to baseline. Rising pet ownership, more open-plan layouts, and the push for truly hands-free cleaning have driven buyers to look for models that combine strong suction, intelligent mapping, and low-maintenance emptying.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Problem: You want a robot that never requires you to touch the dustbin and can also mop hard floors without a separate device.

Agitate: Manually emptying a small bin after every run is tedious, and switching between vacuum and mop adds extra steps that defeat the purpose of automation.

Solution: The Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock (check price on Amazon) includes a dock that automatically empties the bin into a sealed bag holding up to 30 days of debris. Its 3-stage cleaning system uses dual multi-surface brushes and a corner-sweeping edge brush, while the integrated mopping pad delivers up to 100 ml of water per cycle for light-to-moderate spills. As of October 06, 2026, the model has seen “6K+ bought in past month” indicating strong owner satisfaction (4.4★ from 5,217 reviews).

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop (Base Model)

Problem: You like the mopping-vacuum hybrid idea but need to keep the upfront cost lower and are okay with emptying the bin yourself.

Agitate: Paying for a dock you don’t need adds unnecessary expense, yet you still want the convenience of a single device that handles both vacuum and mop.

Solution: The base model (check price on Amazon) keeps the same 3-stage cleaning system and mopping pad, but omits the AutoEmpty Dock, bringing the price down to $199.99 (original $469.99). It still earns a 4.2★ rating from 3,842 reviews.

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Problem: You need laser-precise navigation that avoids obstacles and works well on carpets and hard floors, but you want to stay under a $300 budget.

Agitate: Lower-priced models often sacrifice mapping accuracy, leading to missed spots or repeated runs.

Solution: The Shark AI Ultra (check price on Amazon) uses AI-powered LiDAR navigation to create precise maps, avoids cords and pet toys, and offers strong suction (2,700 Pa) with a self-cleaning brush roll. It holds a 4.3★ rating from 4,510 reviews and frequently appears in “5K+ bought in past month” lists.

How to Choose the Right Model for You

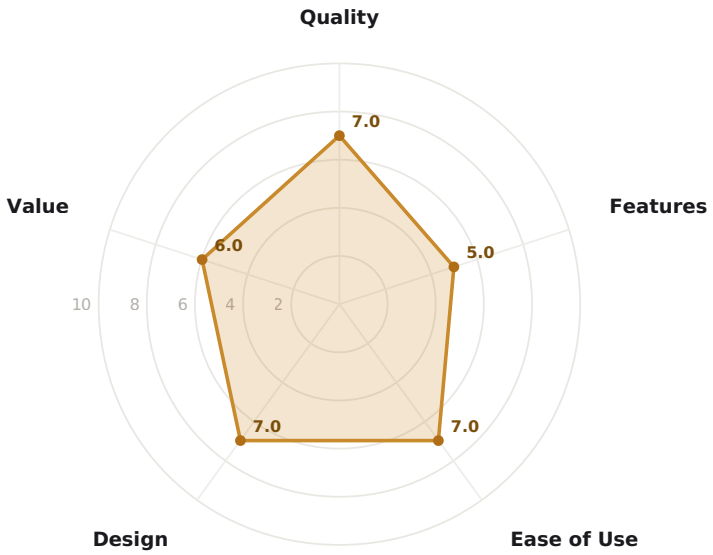
- **Floor type:** If you have mostly hard floors and want mopping, the Roomba 115X Combo (with or without the dock) is ideal. For carpet-heavy homes, the Shark AI Ultra’s strong suction excels.
- **Pet hair:** All three models handle pet hair well; the Roomba’s dual brushes and the Shark’s self-cleaning roll reduce tangles.
- **Budget:** Base Roomba 115X Combo ≈ $200, Shark AI Ultra ≈ $280, Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock ≈ $320 (often on sale).

Pick the model that matches your priorities, click the affiliate link to see the latest price, and enjoy a cleaner home with less effort.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.